Tab. VII

Figures of Snow Crystals

observed under the microscope during the frost of January

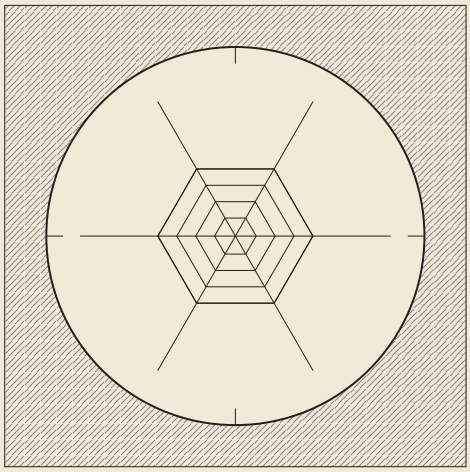


Fig. 1. Simple hexagonal plate.

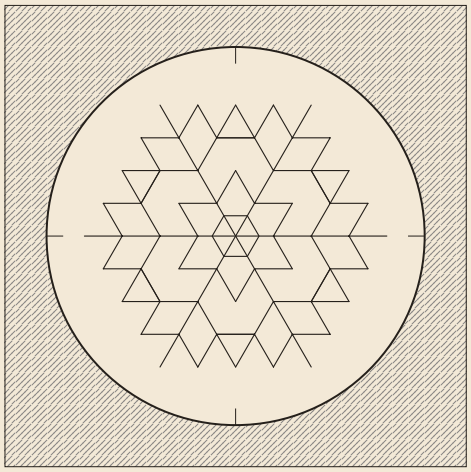


Fig. 2. Stellar dendrite.

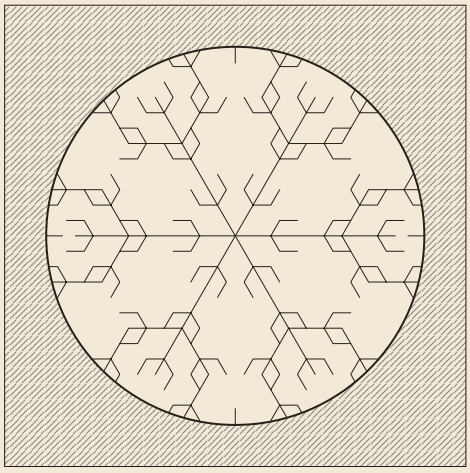


Fig. 3. Fern-like stellar crystal.

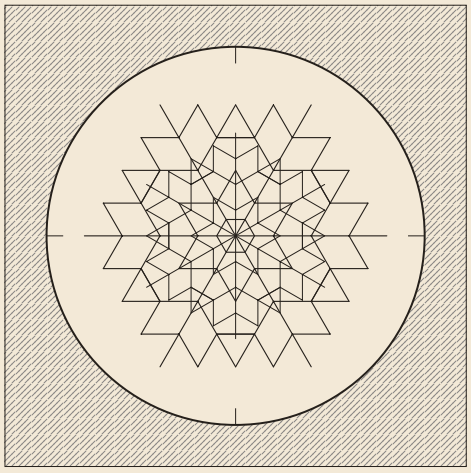
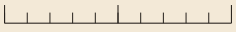


Fig. 4. Twinned crystal with twelve branches.



Scale of the stage micrometer: one millimetre in tenths

Figures 2 to 4 are grown by rewriting grammars rather than drawn by hand. One rule produces a single arm; six rotated copies supply the hexagonal symmetry that a real crystal takes from its lattice, and a second set turned by thirty degrees gives the twinned form. The hatched surround and clipped circular field imitate the appearance of a plate engraved from the microscope eyepiece, and the crystals stay vector paths at every magnification.